

AGENTIC-ARBITER -- FREE-COOLING DECISION REPORT

Data centres over-cool, continuously, because nobody can promise them the hours ahead. A chiller plant needs hours of notice to change mode, and a thermometer only ever reports NOW -- so the mechanical chillers keep running through hours that outside air could have cooled for free. FortyGuard closes that gap with heat intelligence 2 m above the ground, the height a ground-mounted condenser actually breathes. This agent turns that forecast into an hour-by-hour schedule carrying a calibrated safety bound.

THE SITE

Location Digital Realty Silicon Valley SJC37, CA -- station KSJC,
America/Los_Angeles
Committed pair OSM 37947314 -> 209073658
Equinix Santa Clara SV2 / Csquare SF04
Facade gap 205.8 m between the two halls
Weather record 43,747 real hourly records from KSJC
Plume physics 576 steady-state solves on this site's own footprints; worst intake rise
0.3612 C at 5 deg

FortyGuard data: weather and geometry are this site's own; the four measured FortyGuard level offsets and the N-26 coverage record are Ashburn's, because only Ashburn has forecast/outcome day pairs. Quote the hours for this site; quote the coverage for Ashburn.

THIS REPORT IS A SNAPSHOT, NOT THE LIVE PAGE

The interface recomputes the decision for whatever configuration a reader selects. This file was generated at build time for the ONE configuration named below, chosen because it is the configuration in which this site's agent does the most while still changing mode at least once. If the numbers on screen differ from the numbers here, the configuration differs -- compare the two lists before concluding anything else.

Day 2022-05-15 (knife_edge)
Plant limit 18.0 C
Notice required 3 h
Forecast skill 0.50 relative to persistence
Level anchor sensor
Condenser bank longest facade
Switch budget 1 mode changes per day
Minimum dwell 3 h
Max dew point 15.0 C (Green Grid WP#46 p.6)

WHAT THE AGENT DID ON THIS DAY

The agent ran free cooling for 4 of 24 hours with 1 mode change. The reactive incumbent took 9 hours -- 5 more -- but declared 0 unsafe hours against the agent's 0. The incumbent had to break its own switch budget 1 time to stay safe; the agent never did. 9 hours were safe but still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them.

Agent 4 of 24 hours free cooling, 1 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
Incumbent 9 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
the incumbent broke its own switch budget 1 time(s) to stay safe
9 hour(s) passed every gate and still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them

EVERY HOUR, AND THE REASON FOR IT

hh	mode	safe	binding	bound	limit	actual	margin
00	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.752	18.0	15.676	0.838
01	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.472	18.0	15.116	0.752
02	mechanical	yes	switch budget	14.777	18.0	14.022	0.629
03	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.075	18.0	14.465	0.553
04	mechanical	yes	switch budget	14.479	18.0	13.331	0.740

05	mechanical	yes	switch budget	13.936	18.0	13.668	0.690
06	mechanical	yes	switch budget	14.510	18.0	13.915	0.506
07	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.319	18.0	15.265	0.767
08	mechanical	yes	switch budget	16.990	18.0	16.135	0.988
09	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	19.214	18.0	17.222	1.538
10	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.235	18.0	19.155	1.656
11	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.271	18.0	20.338	1.360
12	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	23.101	18.0	21.121	1.390
13	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	23.381	18.0	21.752	1.330
14	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	23.389	18.0	22.321	1.219
15	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	23.111	18.0	22.575	1.125
16	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.772	18.0	21.465	0.861
17	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.205	18.0	20.915	1.020
18	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	19.234	18.0	18.047	1.008
19	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.313	18.0	16.752	1.226
20	FREE	yes	-	17.553	18.0	15.898	1.370
21	FREE	yes	-	16.448	18.0	15.825	1.319
22	FREE	yes	-	15.886	18.0	15.338	0.921
23	FREE	yes	-	14.693	18.0	14.155	0.677

bound = the agent's 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air, forecast plus margin

actual = what the intake temperature turned out to be, from the station record

margin = group-conditional forecast error for that hour of day, plus plume spread

THE REASONING, HOUR BY HOUR

00:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.752 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

01:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.472 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

02:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 14.778 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

03:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.075 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

04:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 14.479 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot

give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

05:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 13.936 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

06:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 14.510 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

07:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.319 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

08:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 16.990 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

09:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 19.214 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 1.214 C. It would take a limit 1.214 C higher, or a bound 1.214 C tighter, to change this hour.

10:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.235 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.235 C. It would take a limit 3.235 C higher, or a bound 3.235 C tighter, to change this hour.

11:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.271 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.271 C. It would take a limit 4.271 C higher, or a bound 4.271 C tighter, to change this hour.

12:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 23.101 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 5.101 C. It would take a limit 5.101 C higher, or a bound 5.101 C tighter, to change this hour.

13:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 23.381 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 5.381 C. It would take a limit 5.381 C higher, or a bound 5.381 C tighter, to change this hour.

14:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 23.388 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 5.388 C. It would take a limit 5.388 C higher, or a bound 5.388 C tighter, to change this hour.

15:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 23.111 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 5.111 C. It would take a limit 5.111 C higher, or a bound 5.111 C tighter, to change this hour.

16:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.772 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.772 C. It would take a limit 3.772 C higher, or a bound 3.772 C tighter, to change this hour.

17:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.205 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.205 C. It would take a limit 3.205 C higher, or a bound 3.205 C tighter, to change this hour.

18:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 19.234 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 1.234 C. It would take a limit 1.234 C higher, or a bound 1.234 C tighter, to change this hour.

19:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.313 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.313 C. It would take a limit 0.313 C higher, or a bound 0.313 C tighter, to change this hour.

20:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 17.553 C, which is 0.447 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.370 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.323 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0476 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

21:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 16.448 C, which is 1.552 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.319 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.262 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0570 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

22:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 15.886 C, which is 2.114 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.921 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.860 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0613 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

23:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 14.693 C, which is 3.307 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.677 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.608 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0688 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

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